

MERIDIAN & ASSOCIATES LLP

Advisory | Assurance | Tax | Consulting

Management Team Bios

Extended Senior Manager & Manager Profiles

CONFIDENTIAL

Version 2.2 | Effective Date: March 2026 | Doc ID: MA-BIO-MGMT-EXT-001

Meridian & Associates LLP | New York | Chicago | San Francisco | London | Singapore

This document is the proprietary and confidential property of Meridian & Associates LLP. It is intended solely for the use of the designated recipient(s). Any unauthorized reproduction, distribution, or disclosure of this material is strictly prohibited. The information contained herein is provided for informational purposes only and does not constitute a binding offer or agreement.

5. Lauren Mitchell, SHRM-SCP

Senior Manager, Organizational Change Management

Years of Experience: 12 years

Office: Chicago, IL

Email: l.mitchell@meridian-llp.com

Professional Summary

Lauren Mitchell is a Senior Manager in Meridian's Organizational Change Management (OCM) practice, leading change strategies for large-scale technology implementations, post-merger integrations, and operational transformation programs. Over her 12-year career, Lauren has designed and executed change management programs for 25+ enterprise engagements, supporting more than 200,000 end users through complex transitions. She is recognized for her ability to quantify change readiness, build executive coalition strategies, and design communications plans that measurably accelerate user adoption.

Lauren manages a team of 18 change management professionals and is responsible for \$8.5 million in annual engagement revenue. Before joining Meridian in 2018, she spent six years at a global management consulting firm and two years in corporate HR at a Fortune 100 healthcare company, where she led the people-side of a company-wide Workday implementation. Her embedded OCM teams consistently achieve adoption rates exceeding 85% within 90 days of go-live, compared to the industry average of 65%.

Education

- MS, Organizational Development, Vanderbilt University Peabody College (2016)
- BA, Psychology, University of Virginia (2012)

Certifications

- Prosci Certified Change Practitioner (Advanced)
- SHRM Senior Certified Professional (SHRM-SCP)
- Certified Professional in Talent Development (CPTD), ATD
- Kotter Change Leadership Certified
- SAFe 5 Agilist (SA)

Technical Specializations

- Enterprise change management for ERP, EHR, and cloud transformations
- Stakeholder analysis and executive coalition building
- Change readiness assessment and adoption metrics design
- Training strategy and curriculum design (instructor-led, e-learning, at-the-elbow)
- Communications planning and employee engagement campaigns
- Post-merger cultural integration and organizational design

Project Highlights

- **12-Hospital Health System Merger:** Led OCM workstream for 24-month post-merger integration supporting

38,000 employees and 4,200 physicians through unified Epic EHR deployment. Designed multi-channel communications strategy, facilitated 220 clinical governance sessions, and achieved 91% end-user proficiency within 60 days of go-live. (See Healthcare Case Study)

- **Fortune 200 Manufacturer:** Directed change management for SAP S/4HANA implementation across 8 distribution centers and 4,500 impacted users. Created role-based training curriculum covering 380 functional specifications, deployed super-user network of 120 change champions, and achieved 88% adoption within 30 days of go-live.
- **State Government Agency:** Managed workforce transition for 1,800-application cloud migration affecting 12,000 state employees. Designed digital literacy upskilling program, retrained 85 mainframe developers in cloud technologies, and achieved 94% employee retention through transition.

Team Leadership

Lauren leads a team of 18 change management professionals including 4 senior consultants and 14 consultants/analysts. She designed Meridian's internal OCM Methodology Toolkit, now used across all advisory engagements, and serves as faculty for the firm's Change Leadership certification program. Lauren is also co-chair of the firm's Women in Leadership employee resource group and mentors six junior professionals.

~~6. Raj Krishnamurthy, MS, AWS ML Specialty~~

Manager, Data & Analytics

Years of Experience: 9 years

Office: San Francisco, CA

Email: r.krishnamurthy@meridian-llp.com

Professional Summary

Raj Krishnamurthy is a Manager in Meridian's Data & Analytics practice, specializing in enterprise data platform architecture, machine learning engineering, and advanced analytics solutions. Over his 9-year career, Raj has delivered 14 data platform implementations and ML production deployments across financial services, retail, and energy sectors. He is recognized for his ability to translate business requirements into scalable data architectures and to bridge the gap between data science experimentation and production ML operations.

Raj manages a team of 16 data engineers and data scientists, responsible for \$7.2 million in annual engagement revenue. Before joining Meridian in 2020, he spent five years at a leading technology consulting firm where he built the data engineering practice from the ground up. His team has deployed 32 production ML models with an average time-to-production of 8 weeks, compared to the industry benchmark of 16-24 weeks.

Education

- MS, Data Science, University of California, Berkeley (2019)
- BTech, Computer Science, Indian Institute of Technology Delhi (2015)

Certifications

- AWS Machine Learning Specialty Certification
- Databricks Certified Data Engineer Professional
- Databricks Certified Machine Learning Professional
- Google Professional Machine Learning Engineer
- Snowflake SnowPro Advanced: Data Engineer

Technical Specializations

- Enterprise data platform architecture (Databricks, Snowflake, BigQuery)
- ML engineering and MLOps (MLflow, SageMaker, Vertex AI)
- Real-time data streaming (Kafka, Spark Structured Streaming, Flink)
- Data governance and quality frameworks (Unity Catalog, Great Expectations, Monte Carlo)
- Cloud data services (AWS, Azure, GCP data stacks)
- Generative AI and LLM application development (RAG, fine-tuning, evaluation)

Project Highlights

- **Top-20 US Specialty Retailer:** Architected Snowflake + Databricks data platform supporting AI-powered demand forecasting across 800+ stores and 45,000 SKUs. Deployed 8 production ML models achieving 23% improvement in forecast accuracy and contributing to \$85M

inventory reduction. (See Retail Case Study)

- **Integrated Energy Company:** Built ESG data platform on Azure for real-time Scope 1/2 emissions monitoring across 8 refineries and 12,000 miles of pipeline. Integrated 2,400+ IoT sensors with sub-minute data latency, enabling SEC Climate Rule-compliant reporting. (See Energy Case Study)
- **Fortune 500 Financial Services Firm:** Designed and deployed enterprise feature store and ML platform on AWS SageMaker supporting 15 production models for fraud detection, credit scoring, and customer churn prediction. Reduced model deployment time from 6 months to 3 weeks.

Team Leadership

Raj leads a team of 16 professionals including 5 senior data engineers, 4 ML engineers, 4 data analysts, and 3 junior consultants. He designed Meridian's Data Engineering Academy, a 16-week upskilling program that has certified 45 consultants in modern data stack technologies since 2022. Raj also serves as the practice's GenAI innovation lead, running quarterly hackathons and maintaining an internal catalog of approved LLM patterns.

7. Sophia Vasquez, CPA, CMI

Senior Manager, State & Local Tax (SALT)

Years of Experience: 14 years

Office: New York, NY

Email: s.vasquez@meridian-llp.com

Professional Summary

Sophia Vasquez is a Senior Manager in Meridian's Tax Practice, leading the State & Local Tax (SALT) service line for the Northeast region. Over her 14-year career, Sophia has advised clients across technology, financial services, manufacturing, and retail industries on SALT planning, compliance, controversy, and incentives matters spanning all 50 states. She is recognized as a leading authority on state income tax nexus, apportionment, and the evolving post-Wayfair sales and use tax landscape.

Sophia manages a team of 20 SALT professionals and is responsible for \$10.8 million in annual engagement revenue. She has secured over \$340 million in cumulative state and local tax savings for clients through audit defense, voluntary disclosure agreements, credit and incentive negotiations, and restructuring strategies. Before joining Meridian in 2015, she spent five years at a Big Four firm in the SALT practice and four years at a state Department of Revenue as a Senior Tax Auditor, giving her valuable insight into the audit perspective.

Education

- JD/LLM, Taxation, Georgetown University Law Center (2014)
- BS, Accounting, summa cum laude, Villanova University (2010)

Certifications

- Certified Public Accountant (CPA), States of New York and New Jersey
- Certified Member of the Institute (CMI), Institute for Professionals in Taxation
- Licensed Attorney, State of New York
- Member, American Bar Association - Tax Section, State & Local Committee
- Member, Tax Executives Institute (TEI) - SALT Committee

Technical Specializations

- State income tax nexus analysis and apportionment planning (post-Wayfair)
- Sales and use tax compliance and automation (Vertex, Avalara, Sovos)
- SALT controversy and audit defense (income tax, sales tax, property tax)
- Credits and incentives negotiation (JDIG, EDGE, BEIP, enterprise zone programs)
- Legal entity restructuring for state tax optimization
- Unclaimed property (escheat) compliance and voluntary disclosure

Project Highlights

- **Fortune 100 Technology Company:** Led comprehensive SALT restructuring that reduced the client's effective state income tax rate from 5.8% to 3.2%, generating \$28M in annual state

tax savings. Designed and implemented IP holding company structure compliant with state economic substance requirements.

- **National Retail Chain (800+ Stores):** Directed post-Wayfair sales tax compliance remediation across 42 states. Implemented Vertex O Series with automated nexus monitoring, reducing compliance risk exposure by \$14M and cutting monthly compliance processing time by 60%. (Relates to Retail Case Study client)
- **Manufacturing Conglomerate:** Managed multi-state audit defense covering \$85M in assessed state income tax deficiencies across 8 states. Negotiated settlements totaling 18% of original assessments, saving the client \$69.7M, and established prospective voluntary disclosure agreements in 3 new states.

Team Leadership

Sophia leads a team of 20 SALT professionals across New York, New Jersey, and Connecticut. She serves as the SALT practice's knowledge management lead, authoring the firm's SALT Policy Alert series distributed to 450+ clients, and co-chairs the Tax Practice's annual SALT symposium. Sophia also mentors 8 junior professionals in the firm's formal mentorship program and teaches the SALT module in the firm's CPA exam preparation program.

8. Thomas Chen, CISA, CISSP, CISM

Manager, IT Audit & Cybersecurity GRC

Years of Experience: 10 years

Office: Washington, D.C.

Email: t.chen@meridian-llp.com

Professional Summary

Thomas Chen is a Manager in Meridian's Risk & Compliance Practice, specializing in IT audit, cybersecurity governance, risk and compliance (GRC), and regulatory frameworks for highly regulated industries. Over his 10-year career, Thomas has led more than 40 IT audit and cybersecurity assessment engagements across financial services, healthcare, defense industrial base, and federal government sectors. He is known for his deep expertise in frameworks including NIST CSF, NIST 800-53, CMMC, HITRUST, and ISO 27001.

Thomas manages a team of 14 IT audit and GRC professionals and oversees \$6.8 million in annual engagement revenue. Before joining Meridian in 2019, he spent five years at a Big Four firm in the IT audit practice and one year as an Information Security Analyst at a defense contractor, where he led CMMC readiness efforts. His dual IT audit and cybersecurity background enables him to assess both control effectiveness and technical security posture in an integrated manner that clients find uniquely valuable.

Education

- MS, Information Security, Johns Hopkins University (2018)
- BS, Management Information Systems, University of Maryland (2014)

Certifications

- Certified Information Systems Auditor (CISA)
- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- Certified Information Security Manager (CISM)
- GIAC Security Essentials (GSEC)
- HITRUST CSF Practitioner (CCSFP)
- CMMC Registered Practitioner (RP)

Technical Specializations

- IT general controls (ITGC) and application controls testing
- Cybersecurity framework assessments (NIST CSF, NIST 800-53, ISO 27001)
- CMMC readiness and certification support for defense contractors
- HITRUST CSF certification for healthcare organizations
- SOC 1/SOC 2 Type II examinations
- Third-party risk management and vendor security assessments
- GRC platform implementation (ServiceNow GRC, RSA Archer, OneTrust)

Project Highlights

- **Defense Contractor (Tier 1 Supplier):** Led CMMC Level 2 readiness assessment and remediation program across 6 facilities. Identified and remediated 142 control gaps, implemented Splunk SIEM and CrowdStrike EDR, and achieved CMMC Level 2 certification on first assessment attempt.
- **Regional Health System:** Directed HITRUST CSF certification for 8-hospital system, managing assessment of 450+ controls across 19 domains. Achieved r2 certification with zero corrective action plans, the first health system in the region to achieve this distinction.
- **Federal Financial Regulator:** Managed annual FISMA assessment covering 22 information systems. Led remediation of 38 POA&M items, implemented continuous monitoring program using Tenable.io, and achieved 'Effective' rating from OIG for the first time in three years.

Team Leadership

Thomas leads a team of 14 professionals spanning IT audit, cybersecurity GRC, and third-party risk management. He developed Meridian's CMMC Practice Accelerator toolkit, which has reduced CMMC readiness assessment timelines by 35%, and serves as a subject matter expert for the firm's defense industrial base pursuits. Thomas is also a certified instructor for the firm's CISA and CISSP exam preparation programs and mentors 5 junior professionals.